

What goes wrong, and why

Nine creasing faults, what causes them, and what to change. Pin this by the press.

MATRIX ENGINEERING

creasingmatrix.com
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Crease cracks when folded

Clean off the press, splits on the folder-gluer.

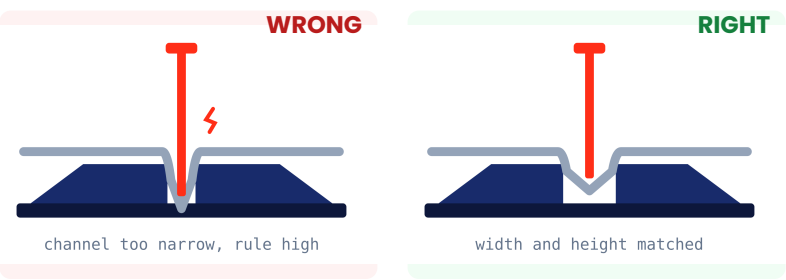


USUALLY
Channel too wide, or rule too low to delaminate the board.

TRY
Next channel width DOWN. Check rule height before pressure.

Crease bursts on the press

Fibres split as it is cut, not later.

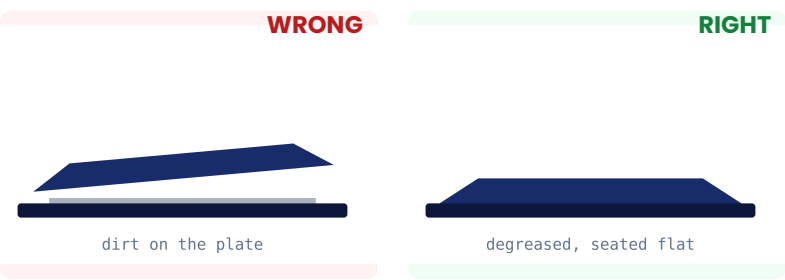


USUALLY
Too much force: channel too narrow, rule too high, or heavy impression.

TRY
One width UP or rule down 0.1–0.2mm — not both.

Matrix lifts off the plate

Moves in the run, or comes away with the sheet.

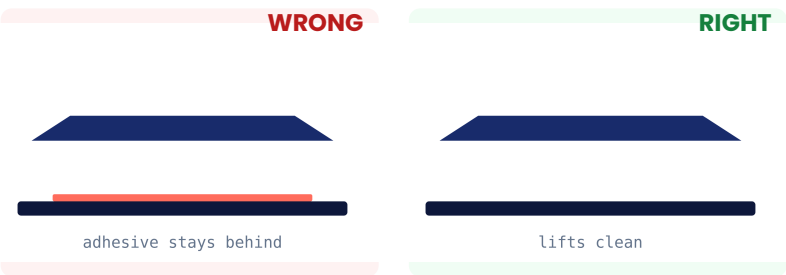


USUALLY
The plate, not the adhesive. Residue, oil or dust under the tape.

TRY
Degrease and dry the plate. Press the full length down.

Residue left at changeover

Matrix comes up, adhesive stays behind.

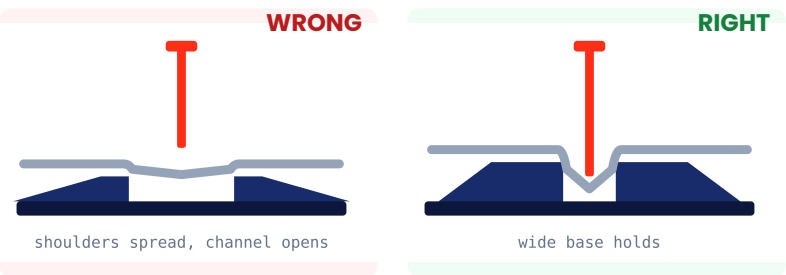


USUALLY
An adhesive formulated to hold rather than to release.

TRY
Lift from one end at a steady angle. If it persists, the matrix is wrong.

Matrix crushes

Creases go shallow mid-run, shoulders spread.

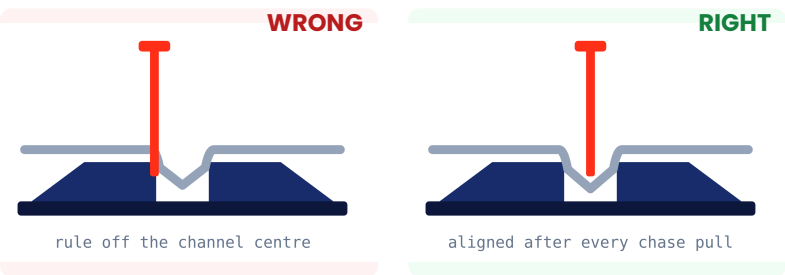


USUALLY
Base too narrow for the load on heavy board.

TRY
Move to a wider base. Check the plate for pitting.

Crease off-centre

One shoulder deeper; carton folds skew.

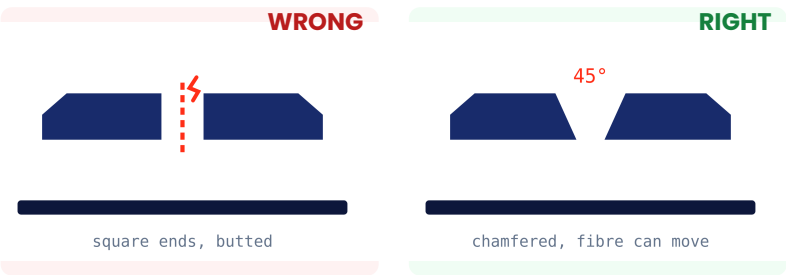


USUALLY
Rule and channel out of alignment.

TRY
Re-check alignment after EVERY chase or plate pull.

Splitting at the corners

Sound along its length, fails at the junction.

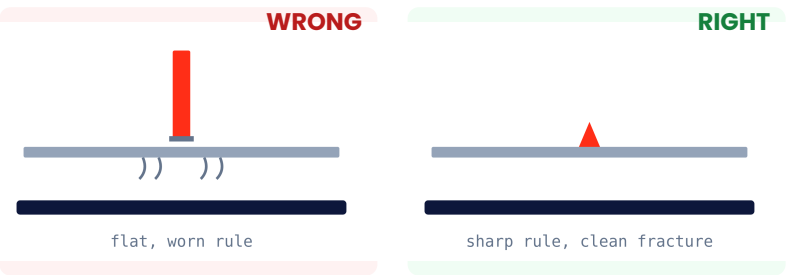


USUALLY
Ends cut square and butted — nowhere for the fibre to go.

TRY
Chamfer the ends at 45°. Use a proper matrix cutter.

Angel hair and dusting

Fine fibres round the cut edge.

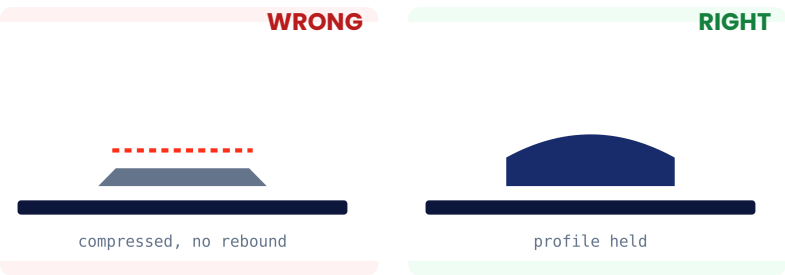


USUALLY
Dull rule first. Then worn plate, over-impression, hard rubber.

TRY
Change the rule. Press a nail into the rubber — no spring, it is done.

Ejection rubber goes hard

Worked when fitted, no longer ejects.



USUALLY
Heat, UV and time harden it; rebound goes, make-ready creeps up.

TRY
Replacing on a schedule not on wear means the wrong rubber.